

drive. If it's taken out of the port while a Windows To Go session is active, Windows 8 will freeze the execution and resume if the device is plugged back in within 60 seconds. If the device is not plugged back in, the system will halt itself. The limited timeframe of 60 seconds has been given to prevent any sensitive data from being displayed on screen. Since Windows To Go is available only on Windows 8 Enterprise which is intended for office use, the duration of 60 seconds is reasonable.

DirectAccess

VPN or Virtual Private Networking is not a new concept. Organizations have been using it since eons to allow someone (well, usually employees) access to the corporate network via the internet. DirectAccess, introduced with Windows 7 is an improved version of VPN. While a VPN connection must be explicitly started by the client, DirectAccess does the same automatically (once you've configured it, of course). DirectAccess needs at least Windows Server 2008 R2 on the server end and operates over IPv6. If the client computer requesting the access is not on an IPv6 network, the traffic is tunneled via 6to4 or Teredo. Once again, the feature is only for Enterprise clients.

BranchCache

Chances are fair that you know about the 'Offline Files' feature. Yeah, the one which enables you to make remote files available on your own computer so that you can work on them from anywhere. When you're done, perform sync and the files are pushed to the server. All well and good. But that's not enough for the more demanding amongst us. BranchCache is the enterprise level offline file caching service for WANs (Wide Area Networks) which needs Windows Server 2008 R2 and above to host files, typically from branch offices of an enterprise (hence the name) so that computers in those branches can easily access the files without having to overload one central server. It not only saves the server from load but also optimizes network usage and increases response times, similar to the way browser saves do by caching images, CSS and JS files in a page.

Other features

While there's no way we can describe all the enterprise elements Microsoft built into Windows 8, these are the most distinguishing features with ADS being the most important of them all. 